

Get a Job at a MAANG Company (Meta, Amazon, Apple, Netflix, Google)

1. Strengthen Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages:** Focus on mastering Java, Python, C++, and C#. These languages are widely used in MAANG companies and form the core of most technical interviews.
- **Data Structures and Algorithms:** Study and practice core data structures like arrays, trees, graphs, and hash maps. You should also be proficient in algorithms like sorting, searching, dynamic programming, and understand their time complexity.
- **System Design:** For senior roles, you'll be required to demonstrate system design skills. Learn to build scalable, efficient systems, and be ready to explain your choices.

2. Build a Strong Portfolio

- Showcase your skills through a portfolio on GitHub or other platforms. This should include real-world projects, open-source contributions, or side projects that demonstrate your problem-solving and coding abilities.

3. Networking and Referrals

- **Networking:** Attend tech events, meetups, or conferences to connect with professionals from MAANG companies. A strong network can help you get insights and referrals for job openings.
- **Referrals:** Ask people in your network who work at MAANG companies for referrals, as this can significantly increase your chances of landing an interview.

4. Prepare for Interviews

- **Technical Interviews:** Be prepared for intense coding challenges. Practice solving problems on platforms like LeetCode and HackerRank to improve your speed and efficiency. Familiarize yourself with typical interview questions and practice under timed conditions.
- **System Design:** Be ready for system design interviews, especially for experienced roles. Focus on scalability, reliability, and explaining the trade-offs in your design decisions.
- **Behavioral Interviews:** Expect behavioral questions that test your teamwork, leadership, and communication skills. Use the STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result) to structure your answers.

5. Tailor Your Resume

- Customize your resume for each job by aligning your skills and achievements with the job description. Use industry-relevant keywords to ensure it passes through Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS). Quantify your achievements to make your impact clear and concise.

6. Understand the Company Culture

- Each MAANG company has a unique culture. Research the company's values and principles, and align your answers with their core philosophies. For example, Amazon emphasizes customer obsession, while Google values innovation and scalability.

Key Areas to Focus:

- **Master Data Structures and Algorithms:** Practice coding challenges regularly.
- **System Design:** For senior roles, be prepared to design complex systems.
- **Behavioral Interviews:** Practice answering behavioral questions using the STAR method.
- **Tailor Your Resume:** Customize your resume for each MAANG company.
- **Networking:** Build connections in the industry and seek referrals.
- **Coding Challenges:** Regularly practice on platforms like LeetCode, HackerRank, and Codeforces.

By focusing on these core areas, you can improve your chances of landing a job at a MAANG company. Preparation, consistency, and a strategic approach are key to succeeding in their rigorous interview process.

1. Importance of Data Structures and Algorithms for MAANG Interviews

Why DSA is Critical

Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) form the foundation of most technical interviews at MAANG companies. They assess your problem-solving abilities, logical thinking, and coding efficiency.

MAANG companies place a strong emphasis on:

- **Optimizing code for time and space complexity.**
- **Clarity of thought and approach in problem-solving.**
- **Ability to break down problems** into manageable parts.

2. Key Data Structures and Algorithm Concepts to Focus On

- **Arrays and Strings:** Basic operations, sliding window, two-pointer approach.
- **Linked Lists:** Singly, doubly linked lists, reversal, cycle detection.
- **Stacks and Queues:** Implementation, stack using queue and vice versa, LIFO/FIFO operations.
- **Hashing:** Hash maps, collision handling, counting problems.
- **Recursion and Backtracking:** Base case identification, recursive tree, solving problems like N-Queens.
- **Dynamic Programming:** Memoization, tabulation, solving problems like longest common subsequence, knapsack problem.

- **Trees:** Binary trees, binary search trees, AVL trees, tree traversals (inorder, preorder, postorder), problems like finding the lowest common ancestor.
 - **Graphs:** BFS, DFS, Dijkstra's algorithm, detecting cycles, topological sorting.
 - **Sorting and Searching Algorithms:** Merge sort, quicksort, binary search, search problems like peak element, first/last occurrence.
 - **Greedy Algorithms:** Interval scheduling, activity selection, Huffman coding.
 - **Bit Manipulation:** Basic operations, finding unique elements, bitmasking.
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3. Recommended YouTube Channels for Learning DSA

Here are some top YouTube channels offering free, high-quality DSA tutorials:

1. **Abdul Bari**
 - **What It Covers:** In-depth explanation of algorithms (sorting, searching, dynamic programming) with step-by-step illustrations.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [Data Structures & Algorithms](#)
 2. **Apna College**
 - **What It Covers:** Beginner-friendly explanations of DSA concepts with a focus on practical implementation.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [Complete DSA](#)
 3. **Tech With Tim**
 - **What It Covers:** Python-based DSA tutorials and basic competitive programming strategies.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [Python DSA](#)
 4. **CodeWithHarry**
 - **What It Covers:** Detailed tutorials with a focus on interview-style DSA problems.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [Data Structures & Algorithms](#)
 5. **Jenny's Lectures CS/IT NET&JRF**
 - **What It Covers:** Concept-driven learning with in-depth DSA concepts.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [DSA in C++/Java](#)
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4. Platforms for Practicing DSA Problems

LeetCode

- **Focus:** LeetCode is one of the most popular platforms for practicing coding problems. It offers problems sorted by difficulty and topics, covering essential topics like arrays, strings, dynamic programming, graphs, etc.
- **Why Use It:** It has real interview questions asked by companies like Google, Facebook, and Amazon.
- **Recommended:** Solve at least **150-200 medium and hard problems**.

HackerRank

- **Focus:** Offers problems on both algorithms and data structures, with a particular focus on competitive coding.
- **Why Use It:** Excellent for beginners as well as intermediate learners, it provides a structured learning path.
- **Recommended:** Aim for high problem-solving accuracy and speed.

Codeforces

- **Focus:** Great for competitive programming and practicing under time constraints.
- **Why Use It:** Enhances problem-solving skills for challenging algorithmic questions, often asked in top-tier company interviews.
- **Recommended:** Participate in contests to simulate real coding challenges.

GeeksforGeeks

- **Focus:** Offers a vast library of problems, tutorials, and company-specific coding problems.
- **Why Use It:** Good for deep-diving into specific topics like dynamic programming, greedy algorithms, etc.
- **Recommended:** Use this as a supplement for in-depth theoretical knowledge and problem walkthroughs.

5. Conceptual and Advanced Learning Resources

- **MIT OpenCourseWare:** For understanding the theoretical aspects of algorithms and their applications. Watch lectures from the MIT course "Introduction to Algorithms".
 - MIT OpenCourseWare - Algorithms
- **CS50's Introduction to Computer Science (Harvard):** An excellent beginner-level resource that introduces core computer science concepts, including DSA.
 - [CS50 Harvard](#)
- **Cracking the Coding Interview (Book):** A must-read for MAANG interview prep. It covers 189 programming questions and detailed solutions, providing a solid base for technical interviews.

6. Important Tips for MAANG Interviews

- **Practice Timed Coding:** Time yourself while solving problems on platforms like LeetCode to simulate interview conditions.
- **Learn to Explain Solutions:** In interviews, explaining your approach clearly is just as important as solving the problem. Practice verbalizing your thought process.
- **Mock Interviews:** Participate in mock interviews on platforms like Pramp or Interviewing.io to get accustomed to real interview scenarios.
- **Master Optimizing Code:** Interviewers at MAANG will often ask you to improve the time or space complexity of your solution, so it's important to be familiar with trade-offs.

7. Structured Learning Path

1. Beginner Level

- Start with **basic data structures** (arrays, strings, linked lists).
- Resources: **Apna College**, **Abdul Bari (YouTube)**, problems from **GeeksforGeeks**.

2. Intermediate Level

- Move on to more advanced concepts like **trees, graphs, dynamic programming**.
- Resources: **MIT OpenCourseWare**, **LeetCode**, **Codeforces**.

3. Advanced Level

- Focus on **system design, graph algorithms, and dynamic programming**.
 - Resources: **LeetCode premium problems**, **Cracking the Coding Interview** book.
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1. Why System Design is Important in MAANG Interviews

System design is a crucial part of senior-level interviews at MAANG companies. These interviews test your ability to:

- **Design scalable, reliable, and efficient systems.**
 - **Explain trade-offs** in terms of performance, cost, and complexity.
 - Understand concepts like **scalability, fault tolerance, load balancing**, and **distributed systems**.
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2. Key System Design Concepts to Master

- **Scalability:** Understanding horizontal vs. vertical scaling, database sharding, and load balancing.
- **Load Balancing:** Techniques to distribute traffic across multiple servers, ensuring availability and reliability.
- **Caching:** Using distributed caching to optimize performance and reduce database load (e.g., Redis, Memcached).
- **Database Design:** Understanding relational (SQL) and non-relational (NoSQL) databases, CAP theorem, and database partitioning.
- **Microservices Architecture:** Designing systems with small, independent services that communicate through APIs.
- **Consistency and Availability:** CAP theorem, eventual consistency vs. strong consistency.
- **Message Queues:** Use of systems like Kafka, RabbitMQ for decoupling services and asynchronous communication.

- **Replication and Fault Tolerance:** How to replicate services and databases to ensure high availability and disaster recovery.
 - **API Design:** RESTful APIs, gRPC, and understanding how to design API contracts.
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3. Recommended YouTube Channels for Learning System Design

1. **Gaurav Sen**
 - **What It Covers:** In-depth system design videos explaining real-world architectures like Facebook, YouTube, and Uber.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [System Design](#)
 2. **Tech Dummies**
 - **What It Covers:** Beginner-friendly explanations of system design concepts such as caching, load balancing, and scalability.
 - **Recommended Video:** [How to Design Scalable Systems](#)
 3. **CodeKarle**
 - **What It Covers:** Explains system design with clear, simplified diagrams and concepts like distributed databases and replication.
 - **Recommended Video:** [Distributed Systems Design](#)
 4. **TechWithTim**
 - **What It Covers:** Provides insights into both coding and design, focusing on API development, database choices, and building scalable architectures.
 - **Recommended Video:** [System Design Basics](#)
 5. **Code Decode**
 - **What It Covers:** Detailed system design tutorials with case studies from companies like Google and Facebook.
 - **Recommended Playlist:** [System Design Tutorial](#)
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4. Recommended Books and Resources

- **Designing Data-Intensive Applications** by Martin Kleppmann
What It Covers: A must-read for learning distributed systems, database design, and real-world data storage techniques.
 - **System Design Interview** by Alex Xu
What It Covers: A comprehensive guide to system design questions with real-world examples and solutions.
 - **The Architecture of Open Source Applications** (Vol. 1 & 2)
What It Covers: In-depth case studies on how large open-source systems were built.
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5. Platforms for Practicing System Design

Excalidraw

- **Focus:** A free web-based tool to draw system design diagrams interactively.
- **Why Use It:** Useful for practicing and explaining your design with diagrams during interviews.
- **Recommended:** Use Excalidraw to simulate whiteboard-style interviews.

LeetCode System Design Section

- **Focus:** LeetCode offers a set of system design questions where you can practice designing scalable systems.
- **Why Use It:** Helps in understanding common design problems like URL shorteners, distributed file systems, and social media feed designs.

Interviewing.io

- **Focus:** Offers mock system design interviews with real interviewers from MAANG companies.
- **Why Use It:** Simulates real interview scenarios and provides detailed feedback.

Pramp

- **Focus:** Provides free peer-to-peer mock system design interviews.
- **Why Use It:** Great for practicing system design interviews with peers who provide constructive feedback.

6. Common System Design Problems Asked in MAANG Interviews

- **Design a URL Shortener:** Discuss how to handle large-scale traffic, hash functions for URL mapping, and database storage.
- **Design a Social Media Feed:** Build a scalable system that supports millions of users, real-time updates, and personalized content delivery.
- **Design a Messaging Queue:** Architect a system like Kafka or RabbitMQ that handles asynchronous messages between services.
- **Design YouTube/Video Streaming Service:** Handle high traffic, content delivery, video encoding, and caching strategies.
- **Design an E-commerce Platform:** Focus on product catalogs, shopping carts, user profiles, and payment processing.

7. Structure for Approaching System Design Interviews

1. **Clarify Requirements**
 - Ask clarifying questions to fully understand the problem's scope.
 - Identify the system's main components: user requests, data storage, and data flow.
2. **Define Scale and Assumptions**
 - Understand the scale (e.g., number of users, request frequency, data size).

- Define assumptions such as read/write ratios, data consistency requirements.
 - 3. **Design High-Level Architecture**
 - Begin by sketching the core components: databases, load balancers, caches, and message queues.
 - Discuss trade-offs between **monolithic** vs. **microservices architectures**.
 - 4. **Detail Specific Components**
 - Explain how you'd design the database (e.g., SQL vs. NoSQL).
 - Focus on APIs, message queues, load balancers, and cache layers.
 - Provide real-world examples of technologies (e.g., Redis, Kafka, AWS S3) used in industry.
 - 5. **Discuss Scalability, Fault Tolerance, and Security**
 - Explain how you would handle scaling (horizontal vs. vertical), replication, and disaster recovery.
 - Discuss data security strategies like encryption, user authentication, and access control.
 - 6. **Optimize for Performance**
 - Explore ways to optimize the system for latency, throughput, and cost.
 - Use techniques like caching, content delivery networks (CDN), and database indexing.
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8. Advanced Learning: Continuous Improvement

- **Kubernetes:** Learn container orchestration to handle microservices deployment and scaling.
 - **Apache Kafka:** Understand message brokers and how they handle distributed communication in real-time.
 - **AWS Solutions Architect:** Get familiar with cloud architectures and design patterns using AWS.
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Building a Strong Portfolio for MAANG Interviews

A well-crafted portfolio is a powerful way to showcase your skills, highlight your projects, and demonstrate your ability to solve real-world problems. It not only serves as a testament to your technical abilities but also reflects your passion and dedication. Here's how to build a strong portfolio that can attract attention from recruiters at MAANG companies.

1. Choose a Platform to Showcase Your Work

- **GitHub:** The most popular platform for developers to showcase coding projects. It allows you to maintain a version-controlled repository, display code quality, and engage with open-source communities.

- **GitLab:** Another version control system similar to GitHub, offering free private repositories for personal projects.
 - **Portfolio Websites:** Create a personal website using platforms like **GitHub Pages**, **Netlify**, or **Squarespace**. This is a great way to have a unique web presence where you can showcase projects, blogs, and your resume.
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2. What to Include in Your Portfolio

A. Real-World Projects

Include projects that demonstrate your ability to solve practical problems. These projects should ideally showcase your work in relevant technologies and domains that MAANG companies are interested in, such as:

- **Web Development:** Build full-stack applications using frameworks like **React**, **Node.js**, or **Django**.
- **Machine Learning:** Demonstrate projects involving real-world data, using libraries such as **TensorFlow** or **PyTorch**.
- **API Development:** Design scalable RESTful APIs or **GraphQL**-based services.
- **DevOps:** Show how you've implemented continuous integration (CI) and continuous deployment (CD) pipelines using tools like **Docker**, **Kubernetes**, or **AWS**.

B. Open-Source Contributions

Contributing to open-source projects demonstrates your ability to collaborate with a larger community and solve real-world problems. It shows your:

- **Collaboration Skills:** Working with maintainers and other contributors.
- **Problem-Solving Skills:** Understanding existing codebases and providing valuable contributions.
- **Commitment to Learning:** Open-source projects often involve complex and large-scale software development.

C. Side Projects

Work on side projects that solve problems you are passionate about. These don't need to be industry-related but should reflect your technical abilities. Side projects are often a great talking point during interviews. Some examples could include:

- A personal finance tracker app.
- A chatbot using **Natural Language Processing (NLP)**.
- A web scraper that collects and analyzes public data.

D. Project Structure

Ensure that your projects are well-documented and easy to navigate. Each project should include:

- **README:** A clear and concise README file describing the project, its purpose, technologies used, installation instructions, and how to run the project.
 - **Code Quality:** Ensure your code follows best practices (e.g., using linters, adhering to clean code principles).
 - **Version Control:** Use branches to track features and bug fixes, and provide clear commit messages.
 - **Unit Tests:** Add unit tests to demonstrate your commitment to writing maintainable and scalable code.
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3. Highlight Your Problem-Solving Abilities

Your portfolio should demonstrate that you can handle complex, real-world challenges. To do this, make sure to:

- Include a section that details the **problem** your project is solving, the **approach** you used, and the **results**.
 - Discuss how you **optimized performance** or **improved scalability** in your projects, focusing on trade-offs you made in your design.
 - Use blog posts or project descriptions to walk through the thought process behind each project. This demonstrates your ability to articulate technical decisions.
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4. Essential Tools for Your Portfolio

- **Markdown:** GitHub repositories use Markdown to format your README files. Use it to structure your documentation and make it more readable.
 - **Excalidraw:** A free tool to create diagrams, especially useful when explaining architecture or system design in your projects.
 - **CI/CD Pipelines:** Set up continuous integration pipelines for your projects using tools like **GitHub Actions**, **Jenkins**, or **Travis CI**. This shows that you understand modern software development workflows.
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5. Learning Resources for Building a Portfolio

- **GitHub Learning Lab:** Offers hands-on learning modules that guide you through GitHub workflows and how to set up a professional project.
 - **Codecademy's Build a Portfolio Website:** A great course to help you create a visually appealing and interactive portfolio site.
 - **Traversy Media (YouTube):** Provides tutorials on how to build complete websites and portfolios using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
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6. Examples of Strong Portfolios

- **Monica Lent's Portfolio:** A simple yet elegant portfolio that showcases web development projects and open-source contributions.
 - **Amie Chen's GitHub:** This portfolio features multiple open-source projects, with detailed READMEs and instructions, demonstrating technical depth.
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Conclusion

A strong portfolio is more than just a collection of projects; it's a window into your skills, your passion for problem-solving, and your dedication to your craft. By showcasing real-world projects, open-source contributions, and side projects, you can demonstrate that you have what it takes to excel in a MAANG interview. Make sure to keep your portfolio up to date and aligned with the job roles you're targeting at top-tier tech companies.

3. Networking and Referrals for MAANG Jobs

A. Networking Networking plays a crucial role in landing opportunities at top-tier tech companies like MAANG. Building connections with professionals in the tech industry can open doors to new opportunities, give you insights into company culture, and help you stay updated with job openings.

Here's how you can build and strengthen your network:

- **Attend Tech Events and Meetups:** Join industry-specific conferences, hackathons, or online meetups where professionals from MAANG companies might be present. Events like **Google I/O**, **AWS re**, and **Apple's WWDC** provide excellent opportunities to meet engineers and managers from these companies. Local meetups focused on programming languages, frameworks, or technologies (e.g., Python, Kubernetes, AI) are also valuable.
- **Conferences and Tech Talks:** Explore virtual and in-person events like **Web Summit**, **Grace Hopper Celebration**, and **PyCon**. These are platforms where engineers, recruiters, and managers from companies like Google and Amazon frequently participate. You can network with them through Q&A sessions or post-talk discussions.
- **Leverage LinkedIn and Twitter:** Follow engineers and recruiters from MAANG companies on LinkedIn and Twitter. Engage with their posts, ask questions, and share insightful comments to start building relationships. Regularly posting content related to technology or your projects can also help attract attention.
- **Join Professional Networks and Tech Communities:** Join tech communities like **Stack Overflow**, **Reddit** (e.g., **r/cscareerquestions**), and **GitHub** where

professionals from top tech companies often contribute. Engage actively in discussions and share your work to gain recognition within the community.

B. Referrals Referrals are one of the most effective ways to increase your chances of landing an interview at a MAANG company. Internal referrals help your resume stand out, as recruiters often prioritize candidates referred by existing employees.

Here's how you can request and leverage referrals:

- **Build Genuine Relationships:** Start by connecting with employees at MAANG companies through your existing network or tech communities. Aim to build a genuine relationship before requesting a referral. People are more likely to refer someone they know well or have interacted with professionally.
 - **Leverage LinkedIn Connections:** Use LinkedIn's "Company" feature to find connections who work at MAANG companies. If you already have mutual connections, ask for an introduction. You can then request a referral once you've established rapport.
 - **Ask for Referrals Politely:** When reaching out for a referral, be clear about the job you're applying for and why you're interested in the company. Make it easy for them by sending your resume and the job link. Be respectful of their time, and understand that not all connections may be comfortable providing a referral.
 - **Alumni Networks:** Tap into your alumni network if your school has an active tech alumni association. Alumni who work at MAANG companies may be more willing to offer insights and referrals.
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Actionable Steps to Strengthen Networking and Referrals

1. **Join LinkedIn Groups** related to your field or where MAANG employees are active, such as groups focused on data science, software engineering, or specific programming languages.
 2. **Participate in Hackathons** like **Google Code Jam** or **Facebook Hacker Cup**, where you can connect with like-minded peers and professionals.
 3. **Contribute to Open Source Projects:** This is a great way to meet engineers from large tech companies and collaborate on real-world projects. Being active in communities like **GitHub** or **Apache Foundation** can help you build credibility.
 4. **Engage with Tech Influencers:** Follow tech leads from MAANG companies on platforms like Twitter. Contributing to discussions can help you get noticed.
 5. **Join Slack or Discord Tech Groups:** Platforms like **Tech Career Growth** and **Turing.com** have dedicated channels for job discussions, career advice, and even referrals. These groups are great for connecting with MAANG employees.
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Networking and referrals significantly increase your visibility and credibility during the hiring process. Focus on creating meaningful connections, contributing to communities, and being proactive in reaching out to potential referrers at the right time.

4. Prepare for Interviews

Technical Interviews

- **Coding Challenges:** Expect a range of algorithmic and data structure problems. MAANG companies focus heavily on coding efficiency, time complexity, and optimal solutions.
- **Practice Platforms:** Use **LeetCode**, **HackerRank**, **Codeforces**, and **GeeksforGeeks** to practice typical interview questions. These platforms have categorized questions based on difficulty and topic, so focus on key areas like arrays, dynamic programming, recursion, trees, graphs, and strings.
- **Timely Practice:** Practice solving problems under timed conditions to simulate the pressure of the actual interview. Regularly solve medium to hard-level problems.

System Design Interviews

- **Focus on Large-Scale Systems:** Be prepared to design systems that can scale to millions of users. For example, design systems like YouTube, Uber, or a social media platform.
- **Key Concepts:** Understand how to use **load balancing**, **caching**, **sharding**, **microservices**, and **distributed databases**. You should be able to articulate why you choose one solution over another (e.g., NoSQL vs. SQL databases) based on scalability, performance, and cost-efficiency.
- **Communication:** Break down your design into components, justify trade-offs (e.g., latency vs. consistency), and be prepared to answer follow-up questions on why you designed the system in a particular way.

Behavioral Interviews

- **STAR Method:** Structure your answers using the STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result) to describe past experiences. This helps you frame responses that showcase teamwork, leadership, problem-solving, and communication.
 - **Practice Common Questions:** Be ready to discuss challenges, failures, and leadership moments. For instance, Amazon has a strong emphasis on its Leadership Principles, so aligning your answers with those values can be beneficial.
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5. Tailor Your Resume

- **Customize for Each Role:** Each job at a MAANG company has specific requirements. Tailor your resume to highlight the skills and experience that align with the job description.
 - **Use Keywords:** MAANG companies use Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS), so ensure your resume includes industry-relevant keywords from the job posting. Focus on technical skills (e.g., Python, distributed systems, cloud services) and role-specific expertise.
 - **Quantify Your Achievements:** Use metrics to showcase the impact of your work (e.g., “Increased server efficiency by 20% through optimization” or “Reduced query response time by 50% by implementing a new caching mechanism”).
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6. Understand the Company Culture

- **Meta (Facebook):** Meta emphasizes **innovation** and building scalable products that connect people. It values open communication, bold ideas, and ownership.
- **Amazon:** Amazon is customer-obsessed, focusing on delivering results, innovation, and frugality. Review their **Leadership Principles** (e.g., Customer Obsession, Bias for Action) and prepare to demonstrate how you align with these values.
- **Apple:** Apple values creativity, attention to detail, and excellence. Focus on your ability to solve complex problems while maintaining simplicity and user-centric design.
- **Netflix:** Netflix emphasizes a culture of freedom and responsibility, with a focus on innovation and being highly self-motivated.
- **Google:** Google thrives on **innovation** and **scale**. It values collaboration, openness, and improving the world through technology. Understand the impact of your work and be prepared to discuss how you’ve made things better at scale.

By understanding the culture of each company, you can tailor your behavioral answers and align your skills with their values. This alignment is crucial for demonstrating cultural fit during interviews.